

have serious doubts about the availability of accessories such as bolts, back plates and arms that are fitted on the wall. We think it's time LCD vendors began to offer these as standard accessories.

OSD (On Screen Display) buttons are the set of buttons on the monitor using which you set the different parameters of the monitor, such as brightness and contrast, geometry, and so on. We found the Samsung 172S to be the best in terms of ease and access of OSD buttons. The Samsung 173P, on the other hand, doesn't have any buttons on the panel for OSD functions; it comes with the MagicTune software to take care of OSD functions.

Landscape-to-portrait mode is a great feature—it's very useful while browsing through a long Web page or Excel sheet. The Samsung 173P was the only model to offer this.

The 173P comes bundled with the Pivot Pro utility which, once installed, rests in the taskbar and allows the user to switch from landscape to portrait mode at the press of a button. Of course, you need to physically rotate the screen. The 173P was also the only monitor to have just a power button onboard. The MagicTune utility is provided to take care of OSD functions. This approach is both good and bad. It's good because you have no buttons on the panel, which adds to the look, and besides, people are more comfortable using a mouse rather than tiny buttons.

It's bad because, if the software is deleted and you don't have the installation CD handy, you're stranded until you get the software from somewhere, somehow!

CMV CT-722A

The CMV CT-722A is the 17-inch LCD of choice for budget users. It's one of the cheapest 17-inch LCDs available, and doesn't miss out on anything as far as performance goes. You won't regret having bought this monitor, whichever way you look at it. In the looks department, it sports the dual-tone black and silver-grey look, which is the in thing right now. There's an 'auto' button that takes care of monitor adjustment—the geometry as well as the contrast and brightness.

Rs 27,000 means this panel is affordable for many SoHo users. Home users would be advised to wait another year for the price to drop further.

+ Affordable; 'auto' button for display correction, looks great

— None

Price: Rs 16,500



CATEGORY		LCD 17"						
Brand		Acer	BenQ	CMV	LG	NEC	Philips	Samsung
Model		AL712	FP767	CT-722A	Flatron L1720B	MultiSync 1760NX	170N	SyncMaster 173P
FEATURES	Pixel size (mm)	0.264	0.264	0.264	0.264	0.264	0.264	0.264
	Luminance (cd/m²)	250	260	400	250	260	260	270
	Contrast Ratio	500:1	500:1	450:1	450:1	450:1	400:1	700:1
	Vertical Scan Rate (Hz)	56 - 76	56.25 - 75	50 - 76	56 - 75	75	56 - 76	56 - 75
	Horizontal Scan Rate (KHz)	24 - 80	31.47 - 83	28 - 62	30 - 83	81	30 - 82	30 - 81
	Maximum Resolution	1280 x 1024	1280 x 1024	1280 x 1024	1280 x 1024	1280 x 1024	1280 x 1024	1280 x 1024
	Video Bandwidth (MHz)	110	135	NA	110	NA	135	140
	Response time (ms)	15	16	16	16	16	25	25
	W x H x D (mm)	374 x 394.5 x 204	382.7 x 404.3 x 200	400 x 388 x 192	394 x 412 x 128	374 x 343.8 x 205	399 x 398 x 197	382 x 236.2 x 395
	Weight (KG)	5.9	3.5	4.3	4.8	6.3	4.7	6
	Built in Speakers (Y/N) / Watts	Y	Y	Y / 2.5 W x 2	N	N	Y	N
	VESA Wall Mount (Y/N)	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
	Swivel/Tilt (Y/N)	N/Y	N/Y	N / Y	N/Y	Y/Y	N/Y	Y/Y
	Power Consumption	54 W	50 W	45 W	40 W	38 W	40 W	40 W
	Bundled Accessories	Power cord	Manuals, colour profile, driver, calibrating software, data cable, audio cable, power cord	Quick setup guide, electronic manual	Power cord, data cable	Naviset colour profile, driver, manual	Data cable, power cable, audio Cable	Natural colour, Pivot Pro, MagicTunes software, drivers, wall-mount accessories, DVI-Data cable, manual, power cable
PERFORMANCE	Displaymate Video Edition							
	Sharpness and Resolution (out of 10)	6	6.75	6.75	6.75	5.75	5.75	6.5
	Greyscale range (out of 60)	36.75	37.25	37.5	36.625	39.25	42.25	42.75
	Miscellaneous tests							
	Viewable angle test (degrees)	150	150	150	150	3.75	150	3.875
OVERALL SCORE	Image persistence (scale of 5)	3.5	3.5	3.75	3.75	2.5	3.75	3.625
	OSD usability test (scale of 5)	3.25	3.75	3.5	3.5	2.5	3.75	3.625
	Overall Scores							
	Features	25	30	26	25	28	29	36
	Performance	39.45	40.3	39.45	39.35	39.5	43.25	44.3
OVERALL SCORE	Overall Score (Performance + Features)	64.45	70.3	65.45	64.35	67.5	72.25	80.3
	Value for Money	2.91	3.08	3.39	2.82	2.74	3.37	2.25
	Price (Rs)	30,999	32,000	27,000	32,000	34,500	30,000	47,500
	Grade	B	B	B+	B-	B-	B+	B-